

PAYX - Research Report

Paychex, Inc. · Technology / Software - Application
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INTERNAL

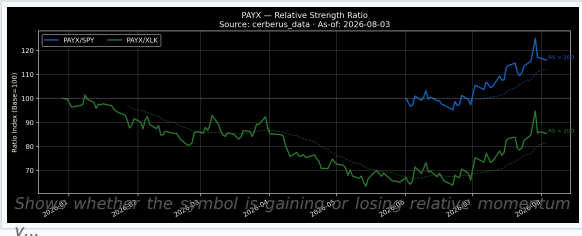
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SCORE 58.67/100	VERDICT Monitor for reclaim	PRICE 117.67
SETUP Breakout @ 124.74	TARGET GAP target gap -6.88%	R/R 2.0:1
NEXT EARNINGS 2026-09-29		
Catalysts Earnings on 2026-09-29 Dividend recorded 2026-07-27		
Risks Analyst target gap -6.88%		
Setup Setup: Breakout Trigger: Level / Status Invalid: 109.93 / EMA21 112.49 Target: 133.15		

Executive Summary

- Score: 58.67/100
- MONITOR
- State: Hold / Neutral
- State: Uptrend / Trend-Up

Relative Strength Ratio



CONTENTS

- 01 Executive Summary & Verdict
- 02 Data Quality
- 03 Data Freshness Brief
- 04 Investment Case
- 05 Decision Dashboard
- 06 Report Summary
- 07 Thesis Delta Brief
- 08 Conviction Gradecard
- 09 Price Snapshot
- 10 Setup / Risk Dashboard
- 11 Setup Quality Grade
- 12 Catalyst Summary Card
- 13 Scenario Analysis
- 14 Key Debate

Generated from Cerberus research markdown export.

Executive Summary & Verdict

****NEUTRAL HOLD / NEUTRAL****

NOTE

Technical Score: 58.67/100 · Verdict: MONITOR · Advice: Hold / Neutral

Pillar	Assessment
Market Cycle	Stage 2 — Uptrend OK
Trend / Regime	Uptrend / Trend-Up
TTM Squeeze	—
Valuation (P/E)	23.87x
Net Margin	26.63% OK
Earnings Growth	43.40% OK
Debt/Equity	123.97 OK
Analyst Mean Target	\$109.57 — -6.88% from current

Data Quality

PROVIDER QUALITY SCORE 90.00/100	EFFECTIVE REPORT CONFIDENCE 45.00/100
FRESHNESS STATUS STALE DATA	

Data Freshness Brief

STATUS STALE	FRESH / STALE / UNKNOWN 0 / 25 / 1
TRACKED DATASETS 26	DETAIL LOCATION Appendix / Data Freshness & Provenance

Investment Case

THESIS Hold / Neutral (MONITOR setup)	VERDICT MONITOR
TIME HORIZON Swing	ENTRY / TRIGGER 124.74
STOP / INVALIDATION 109.93 (-6.58%)	TRADE TARGET 133.15 (13.16%)
ANALYST MEAN TARGET 109.57 (-6.88%)	REWARD / RISK 2.00:1

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NEXT CATALYST
2026-09-29

POSITIONING
major \$72.37M / retail \$-2.44M

Investment Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	favorable asymmetry
Implication	setup supports action if trigger clears
Watch Next	trigger 124.74 and catalyst 2026-09-29
Confidence	high

Decision Dashboard

Lens	Read	Lens	Read
Trend	100.00	Momentum	73.85
Risk Adjusted	94.97	Confidence	17.35
Valuation	Fair	Flows	Accumulation
Macro Regime	neutral	Event Window	56d
Relative Context	15.92% vs benchmark	Setup	Uptrend / Trend-Up

Dashboard Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	signal stack supportive
Implication	thesis has broad internal support
Watch Next	flows accumulation and event window 56d
Confidence	medium / conflicting signals

Report Summary

Lens	Summary
Thesis	Hold / Neutral
Score / Verdict	58.67 / MONITOR
Strongest Evidence	Trend 100.00
Biggest Drag	Drawdown 0.00
Catalyst	2026-09-29
Invalidation	109.93
Flow Backdrop	\$72.37M

Summary Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	summary supports current call
Implication	thesis still needs cleaner confirmation
Watch Next	watch catalyst 2026-09-29 and flow follow-through
Confidence	medium / stale inputs

Thesis Delta Brief

Lens	Read
Status	Unavailable
Reason	No previous same-profile report artifact found for delta comparison.

Conviction Gradecard

Pillar	Weight	Score
Trend	35%	100.00
Momentum	30%	73.85
Risk-Adjusted	20%	94.97
Valuation	15%	55.00
Composite	100%	84.40 (A / High Conviction)

Confidence Decomposition

Driver	Value
Strong: Trend	100.00
Strong: Risk Adjusted	94.97
Strong: Momentum	73.85
Weak: VWAP	0.00
Weak: Drawdown	0.00
Weak: Bollinger	22.37
Read	Support led by Trend, Risk Adjusted, Momentum; drag from VWAP, Drawdown, Bollinger

NOTE

Score Bars: Momentum 74 | Trend 100 | RiskAdj 95 | VolStab 67

Price Snapshot

Snapshot

PRICE \$117.67	MARKET CAP \$41.85B
52W HIGH \$141.89	52W LOW \$85.45
DIVIDEND YIELD 4.05%	
TRAILING P/E 23.87	FORWARD P/E 18.43
EPS (TTM) 4.93	SHARES OUT 355.68M

Returns

1Y	YTD	MTD	WTD	1D
-15.61%	+8.35%	+0.00%	+0.00%	+0.71%

Setup / Risk Dashboard

CURRENT PRICE 117.67	PRIMARY TRIGGER 124.74
STOP 109.93	TRADE TARGET 133.15
STREET HIGH TARGET 150.00	REWARD / RISK 2.00:1
ATR(14) 3.87	EXPECTED MOVE BAND 3.29%

Setup Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	risk map actionable
Implication	trade can be planned before entry
Watch Next	break 124.74 with stop held above 109.93
Confidence	high

Setup Quality Grade

GRADE B	COMPOSITE SETUP SCORE 63.19
SIGNAL STACK trend 100.00, momentum 73.85, confidence 17.35	REWARD / RISK 2.00:1

Upside to Target

13.16%

Room to Stop

-6.58%

Catalyst Summary Card

Next Earnings

2026-09-29

Earnings Countdown

56d

Expected Move Proxy

3.29%

Latest Dividend / Split

2026-07-27

Top Catalysts

Earnings on 2026-09-29 ; Dividend recorded 2026-07-27 ; Technical posture Uptrend / Trend-Up

Top Risks

Analyst target gap -6.88%

Scenario Analysis

Scenario	Trigger	Path	Consensus Context	Fail Condition	Probability
Bull	break > 124.74	trade target 133.15 (+13.16%)	analyst mean 109.57 (-6.88%)	lose 109.93	24%
Base	hold > 117.67	drift to 122.31 (+3.95%)	analyst mean 109.57 (-6.88%)	fail to reach 133.15	44%
Bear	lose 109.93	path 109.93 (-6.58%)	analyst mean 109.57 (-6.88%)	reclaim 124.74	32%

Key Debate

Side	Framing
Bull Case	trend and momentum support continuation
Bear Case	street target only implies -6.9% upside
Decision Variable	confidence 17.35, major flow \$72.37M, momentum 73.85

Key Reasons

Side	Detail
Reasons To Be Long	trend score 100
Reasons To Be Long	momentum score 74
Reasons To Be Long	5D major flow \$72.37M
Reasons Not To Be Long	signal confidence 17%
What Changes The Call	Hold / Neutral breaks if stop fails or catalyst path deteriorates



Figure 1. Price Chart - Candlestick + SMA + Volume + RSI (1Y)

Chart Read: Shows the primary price trend, participation, and momentum backdrop.

Read: setup offers about 13.2% upside versus 7.0% stop distance. Why it matters: combines trend, participation, and execution levels in one view. Source: local market data · As-of: 2026-08-03

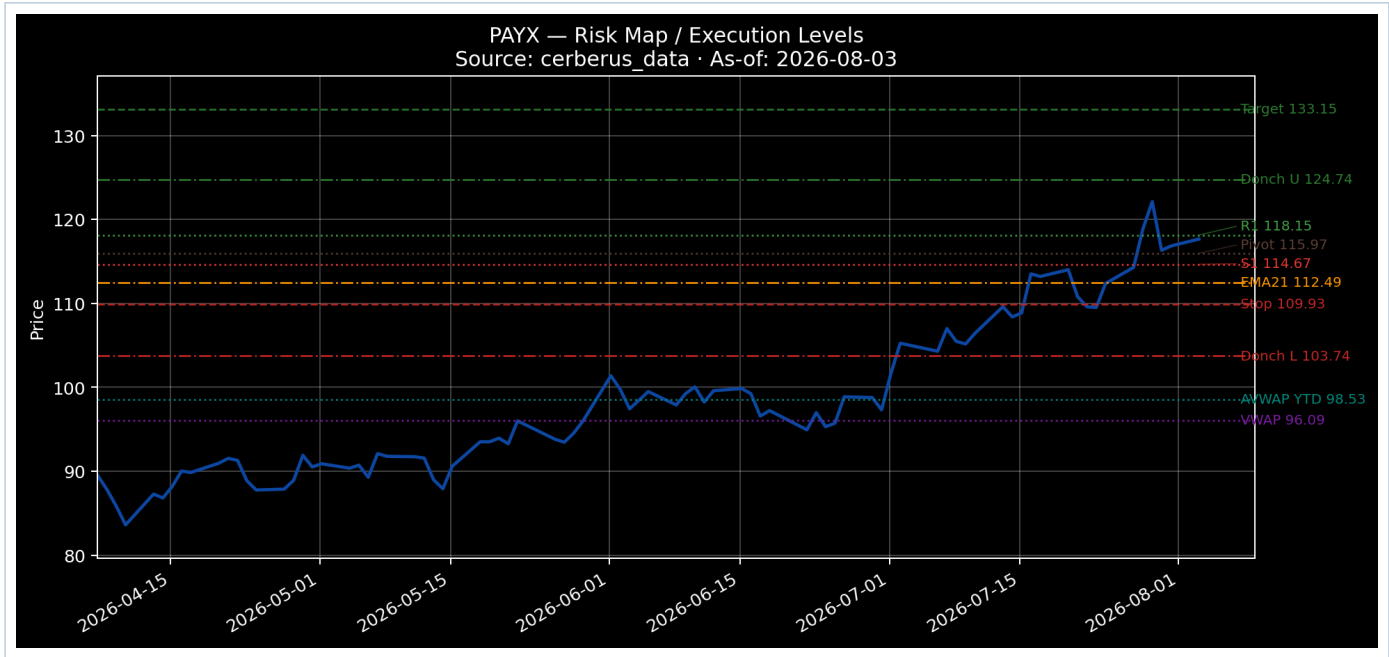


Figure 2. Risk Map and Execution Levels

Chart Read: Maps trigger, stop, and target levels into one execution view.

Read: payoff skew is favorable if trigger quality holds. Why it matters: makes trigger, invalidation, and target explicit. Source: technical indicators · As-of: 2026-08-03

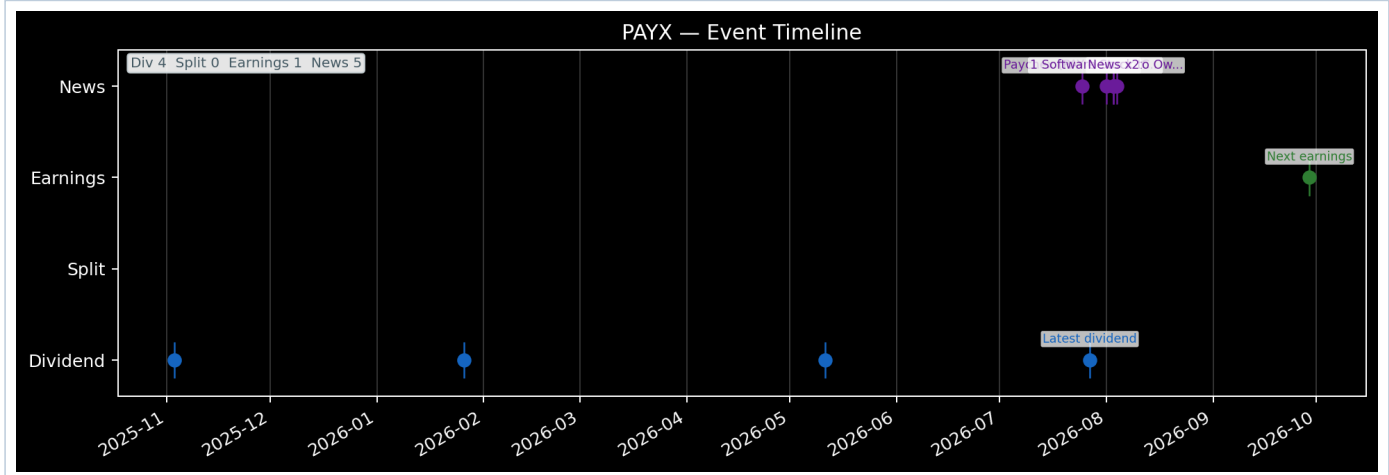


Figure 3. Catalyst and Event Timeline

Chart Read: Shows when key corporate events and headline catalysts occurred or are upcoming.

Read: next event window centers on 2026-09-29. Why it matters: timing of catalysts drives path dependence for the setup. Source: SEC events + earnings + news · As-of: 2026-07-21

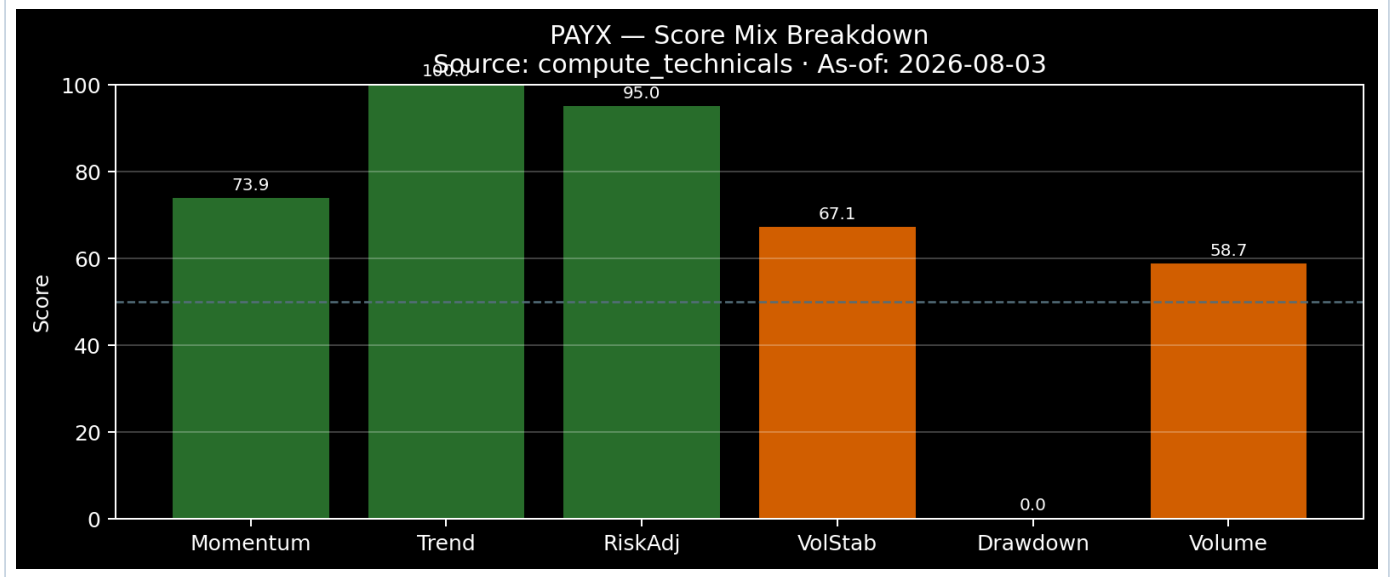


Figure 4. Score Mix Breakdown

Chart Read: Shows which technical sub-scores are carrying conviction and which remain weak.

Why it matters: shows which score drivers are carrying or dragging conviction. Source: technical scoring · As-of: 2026-08-03

Peer / Benchmark Snapshot

PRIMARY BENCHMARK SPY	6M RELATIVE VS PRIMARY 15.92%
SECTOR BENCHMARK XLK	6M RELATIVE VS SECTOR -6.41%
MEDIAN PEER 6M RELATIVE -3.32%	NET MARGIN VS PEER MEDIAN 26.63% vs -

Relative Strength / Benchmark Context

1Y RETURN (SYMBOL) -15.61	YTD RETURN (SYMBOL) 8.35
PRIMARY BENCHMARK SPY	BENCHMARK-RELATIVE RETURN (6M) 15.92%
SECTOR/PEER BENCHMARK XLK	INDEX MEMBERSHIP nasdaq100, sp500
EXCHANGE / TYPE NMS / EQUITY	INTERPRETATION leader

Horizon	Symbol	Benchmark	Spread
1M	11.80%	1.73%	10.07%
3M	29.70%	0.14%	29.56%
6M	22.68%	0.14%	22.54%

Horizon	Symbol	Benchmark	Spread
1Y	-13.85%	0.14%	-13.99%
PRIMARY BENCHMARK SPY		6M RELATIVE RETURN VS SPY 15.92%	
SECTOR BENCHMARK XLK		6M RELATIVE RETURN VS SECTOR -6.41%	
PEER RANK 2/7		PEER PERCENTILE 83.33%	
BREADTH (PEERS POSITIVE 1Y) 3/6		BREADTH (PEERS POSITIVE 6M REL) 2/6	
MA PARTICIPATION 4/4 above		INDEX MEMBERSHIP nasdaq100, sp500	
INTERPRETATION outperforming primary benchmark; trailing sector peer benchmark; top-tier peer momentum; above 4/4 key MAs		PEER READ crowded	
LEADERSHIP Leader		CROWDING Clean	
POSTURE Cyclical		PRIMARY RELATIVE 15.92%	
SECTOR RELATIVE -6.41%		PEER PERCENTILE 83.33%	
CONCLUSION leader; vs primary benchmark positive; sector leadership weak; clean positioning			

Relative Strength Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	relative leadership confirmed
Implication	outperformance supports staying in the name over the benchmark
Watch Next	relative ratio and breadth must stay aligned
Confidence	high

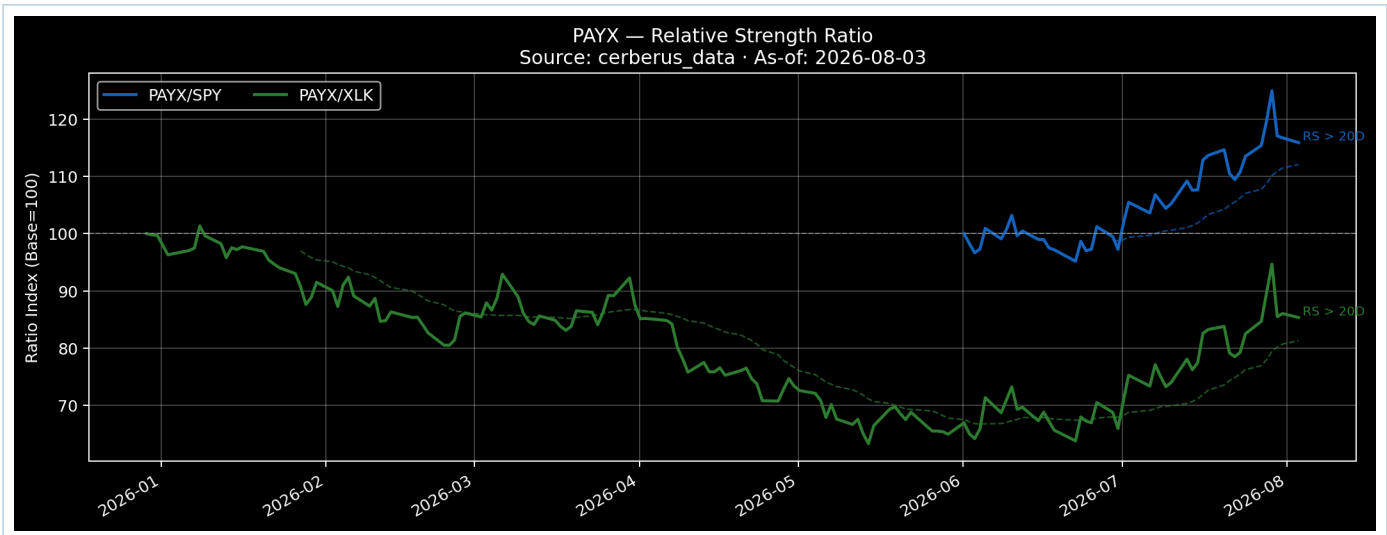


Figure 5. Relative Strength Ratio

Chart Read: Shows whether the symbol is gaining or losing relative momentum versus its benchmark.

Read: beating SPY by 15.9%. Why it matters: confirms whether the symbol is actually outperforming its benchmark set. Source: local market data vs benchmark · As-of: 2026-08-03

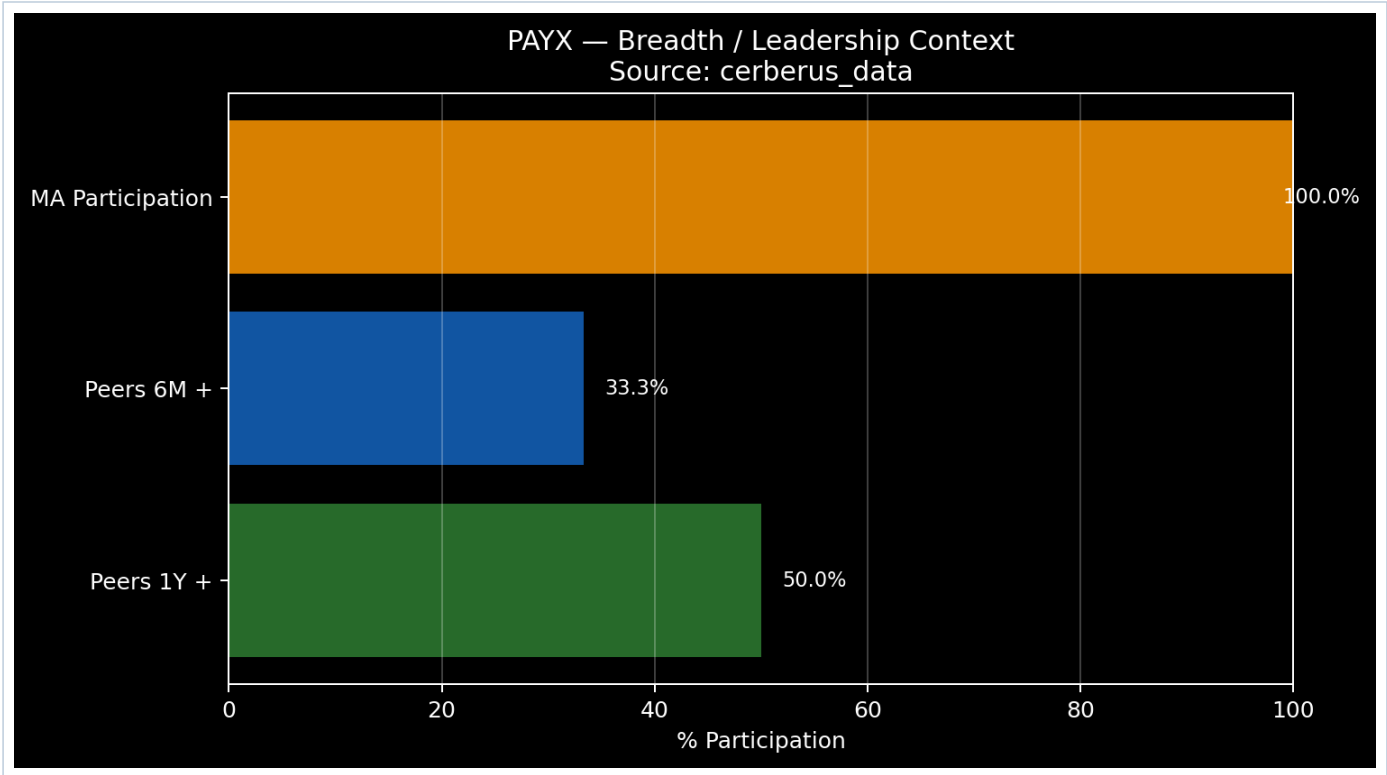


Figure 6. Breadth and Leadership Context

Chart Read: Shows how broadly supported the move is across peers and moving-average participation.

Why it matters: tests whether leadership is broad or narrow versus peers. Source: peer snapshot / local market data · As-of: 2026-08-03

Peer Allocation View

NOTE
Peer cut vs SPY using local index/sector mapping.

Lens	Subject	Peer Medi...	Verdict
6M Relative Return	15.92%	-3.32%	Leader
1Y Return	-15.61%	4.63%	Laggard
Net Margin	26.63%	—	Unavailable
Operating Margin	38.32%	—	Unavailable
5D Major Flow	\$72.37M	\$-16.30M	Leader
Panel Verdict	leader / leader	6 peers	SPY

Benchmark-relative context vs SPY using local sector/index peers.

Symbol	1Y Return	6M Rel	Net Mar...	Op Margin	5D Major Flow
ADP	-8.40%	16.15%	—	—	\$-10.26M
ABNB	17.67%	9.12%	—	—	\$1.04M
AAPL	50.38%	-1.09%	—	—	\$-8.84B
ADSK	-20.98%	-5.56%	—	—	\$-4.01M
ADBE	-27.73%	-8.42%	—	—	\$-128.92M
ADI	64.96%	-10.03%	—	—	\$-22.34M

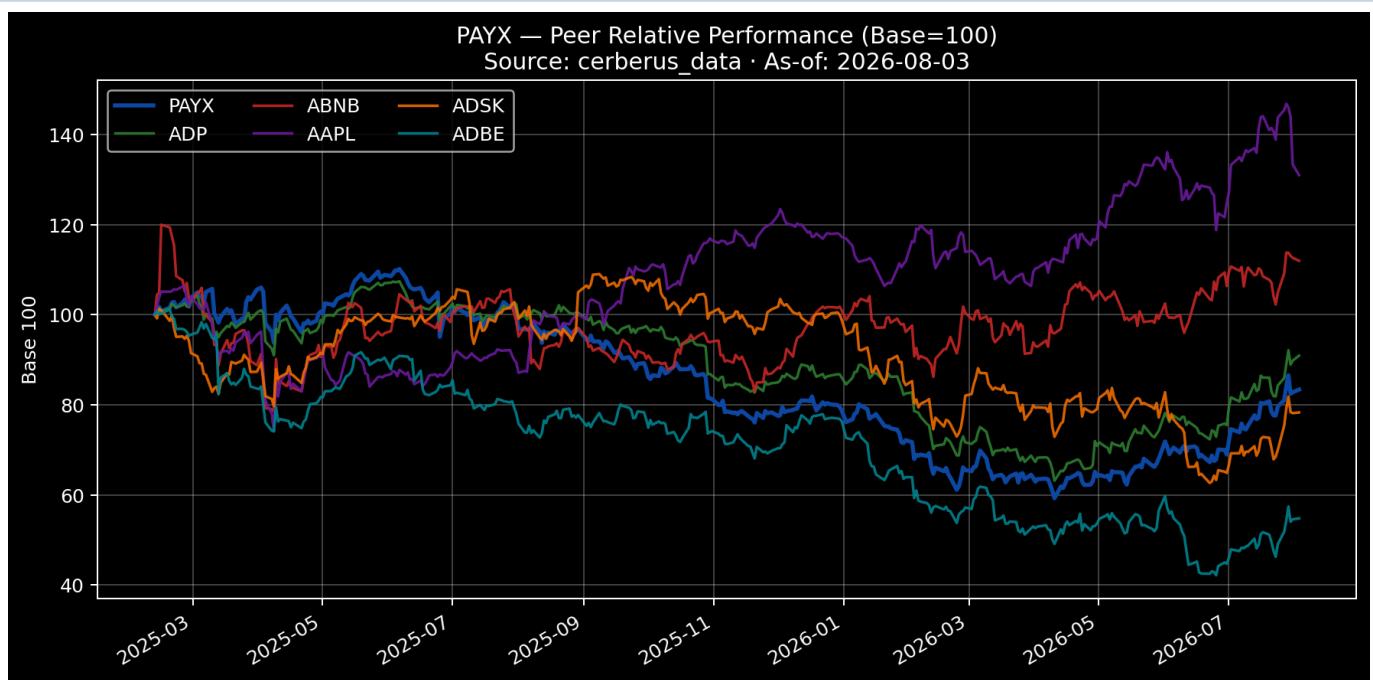


Figure 7. Peer Relative Performance (1Y, Base=100)

Read: relative performance sits near the 83th peer percentile. Why it matters: frames the allocation decision versus comparable alternatives. Source: peer snapshot / local market data · As-of: 2026-08-03

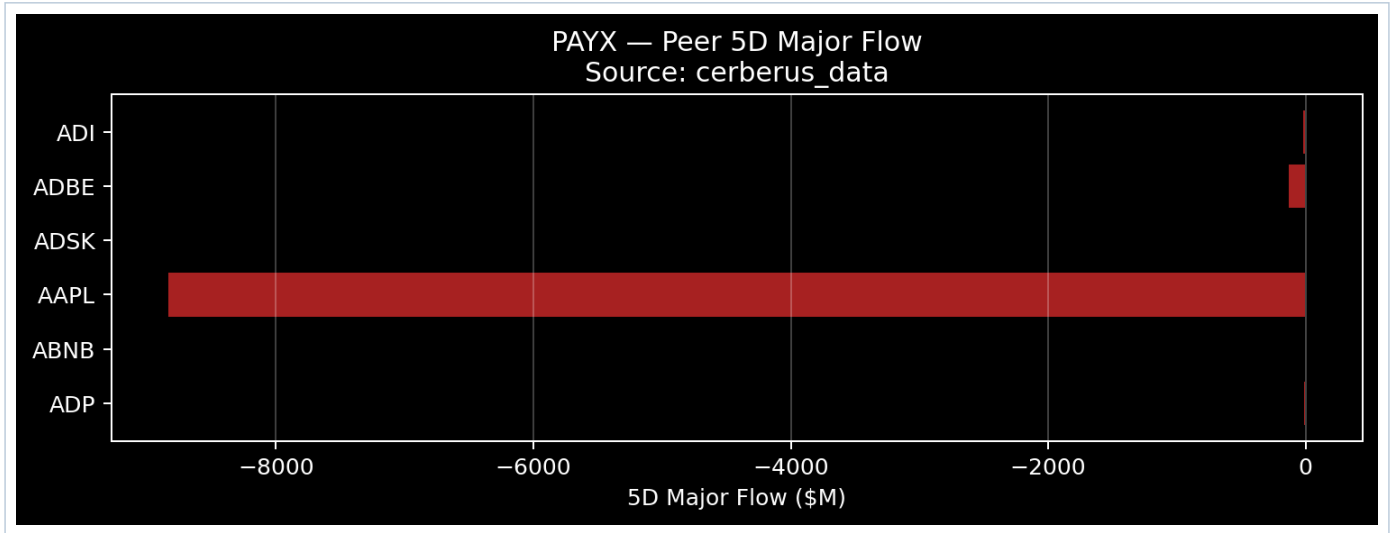


Figure 8. Peer 5D Major Flow

Why it matters: highlights where institutional flow is concentrating inside the peer set. Source: peer snapshot flows · As-of: 2026-07-31

Flow / Positioning Dashboard

AS OF 2026-07-31	MAJOR NET FLOW \$656.33K
RETAIL NET FLOW \$1.53M	MEDIUM NET FLOW \$1.00M
SMALL NET FLOW \$527.80K	5D MAJOR NET FLOW \$72.37M
5D RETAIL NET FLOW \$-2.44M	MAJOR INFLOW RATIO 0.05
MAJOR OUTFLOW RATIO 0.04	RETAIL INFLOW RATIO 0.47
RETAIL OUTFLOW RATIO 0.45	MAJOR DAILY Z-SCORE (20D) -0.01
SOURCE cerberus_data	FLOW TREND Institutional accumulation

Peer	5D Major Flow
ABNB	\$1.04M
ADSK	\$-4.01M
ADP	\$-10.26M

Flow Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	flows mixed
Implication	positioning is confirming the tape

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Lens	Insight
Watch Next	watch for price/major-flow divergence to widen or close
Confidence	medium / conflicting signals

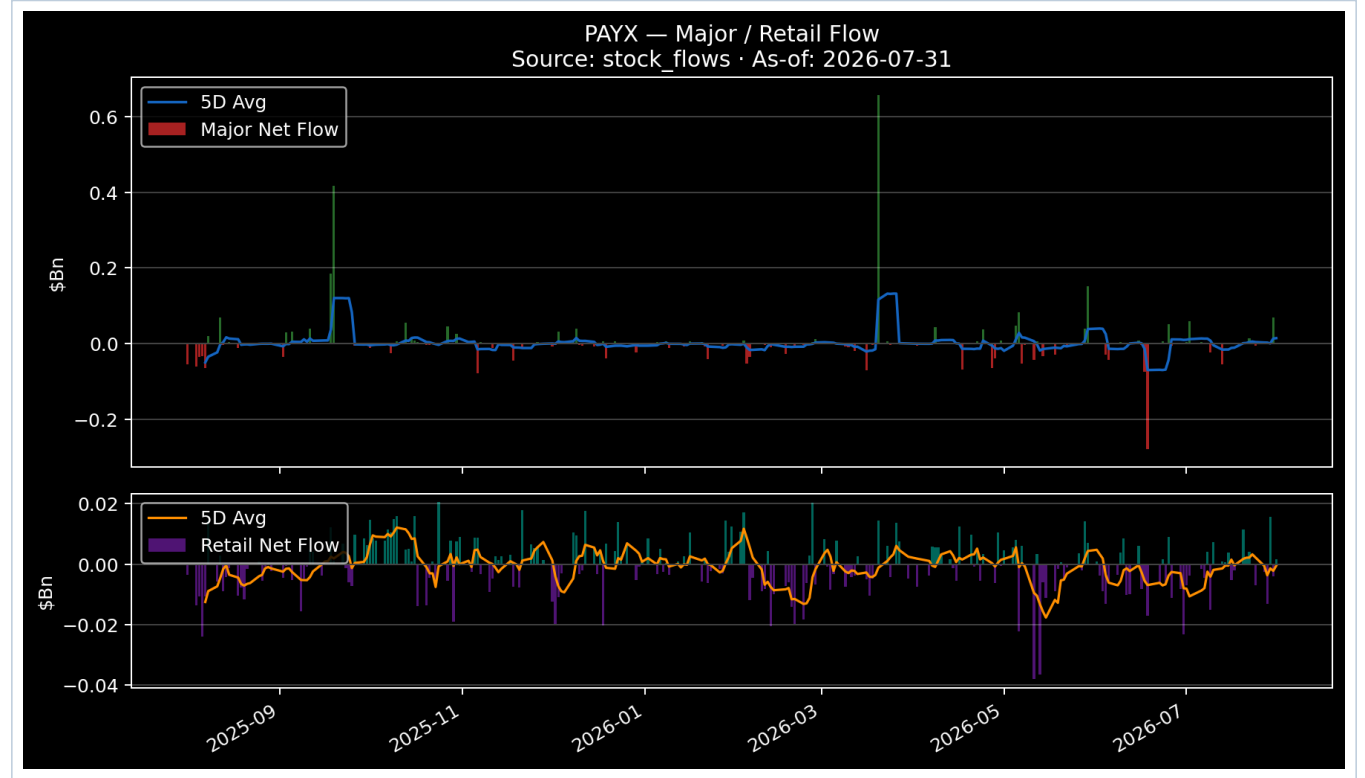


Figure 9. Major and Retail Flow Trend

Chart Read: Shows whether institutional and retail flows are confirming or fighting the tape.

Read: institutional flow supportive. Why it matters: shows whether positioning is confirming or fading the tape. Source: stock_flows · As-of: 2026-07-31

AAII Retail Sentiment

AS OF 2026-07-23	BULLISH 29.59%
NEUTRAL 28.06%	BEARISH 42.35%
BULL-BEAR SPREAD -12.76	READ retail bearish

CBOE Volatility & Risk Premium

AS OF 2026-07-31	VIX9D 16.38
VIX 7.69	VIX3M 19.02
SKEW 141.23	TERM SLOPE (VIX3M - VIX9D) 2.64

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BXM
2490.46

PUT INDEX
3557.59

Index	Value
LONGVOL	5.31
LOVOL	566.03
LTV	8.00
SHORTVOL	1766.07
SMILE	2526.34

Read: complacency

Macro / Liquidity / Positioning Dashboard

STATE
neutral

OVERALL SCORE
0.19

AS OF
2026-07-31

Component	Score
Liquidity	0.25
Volatility	-0.33
Breadth	1.00
Crowding	0.25
Rates	0.00
Macro Revision	0.00

Neutral tape; prioritize selectivity and benchmark-relative confirmation.

AS OF
2026-07-31

TAPE STATE
Neutral

TOTAL PUT/CALL
0.91

EQUITY PUT/CALL
0.63

INDEX PUT/CALL
1.01

SKEW
141.23

VIX3M CLOSE
19.02

SPOTVOL CLOSE
7.69

VOL TERM PREMIUM
11.33

forward vol above spot

AS OF
2026-07-31

NET LIQUIDITY
\$5.83K

CREDIT SPREAD 0.80	HY SPREAD 2.84
YIELD CURVE 0.47	FINANCIAL STRESS -0.83
NFCI -0.55	10Y TERM PREMIUM 0.84
INTERPRETATION net liquidity positive	
NAAIM AS OF 2026-07-22	NAAIM EXPOSURE 84.02
NAAIM RANGE -25.00 / 200.00	NAAIM QUANTILES 85.00 / 95.50 / 100.00
NAAIM DISPERSION 43.61	DIX/GEX AS OF 2026-07-31
DIX 0.46	GEX \$5.74B
DIX Z-SCORE (20D) 0.82	GEX Z-SCORE (20D) 0.15
READ Crowded long; dark-pool accumulation	

Macro Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	macro backdrop mixed
Implication	macro should not be the only driver
Watch Next	watch regime state, liquidity stress, and sentiment crowding together
Confidence	high

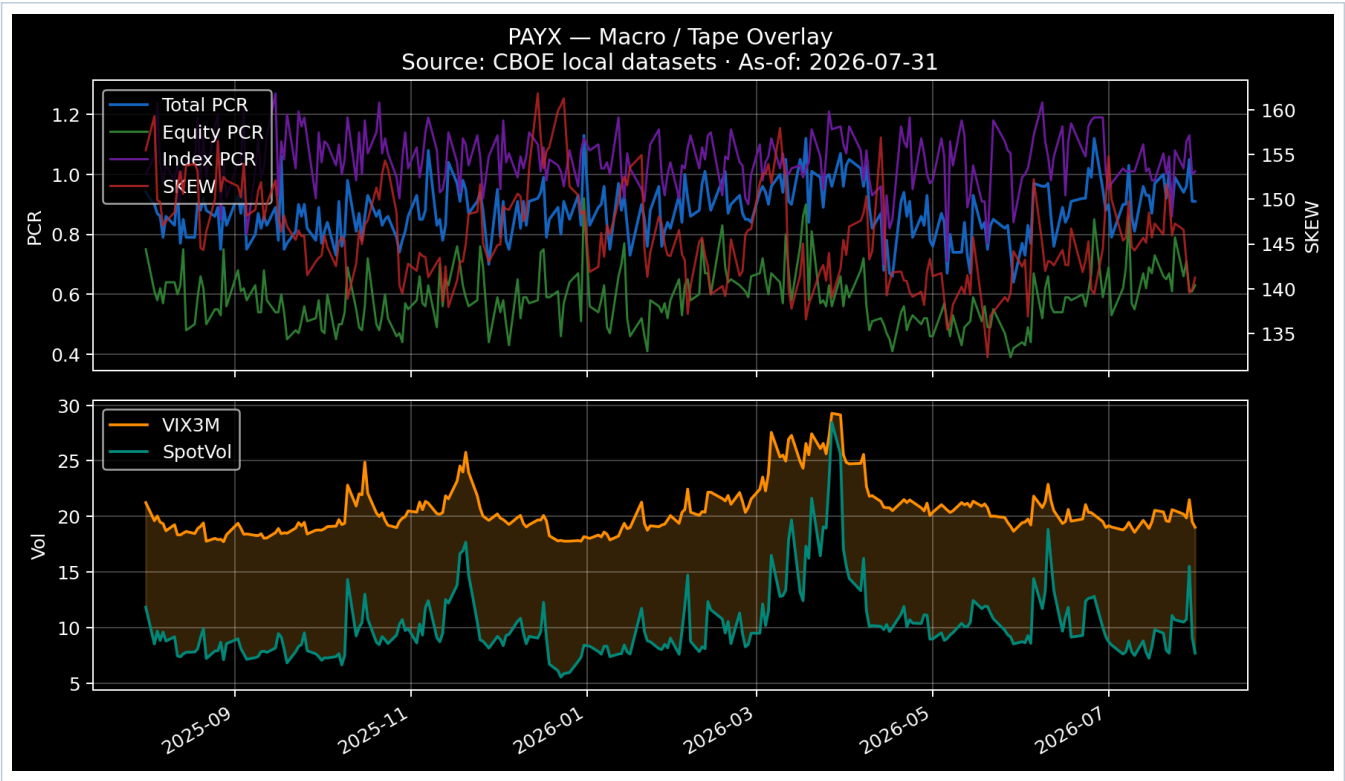


Figure 10. Macro and Tape Overlay

Why it matters: macro positioning can amplify or cap setup follow-through. Source: CBOE local datasets · As-of: 2026-07-31

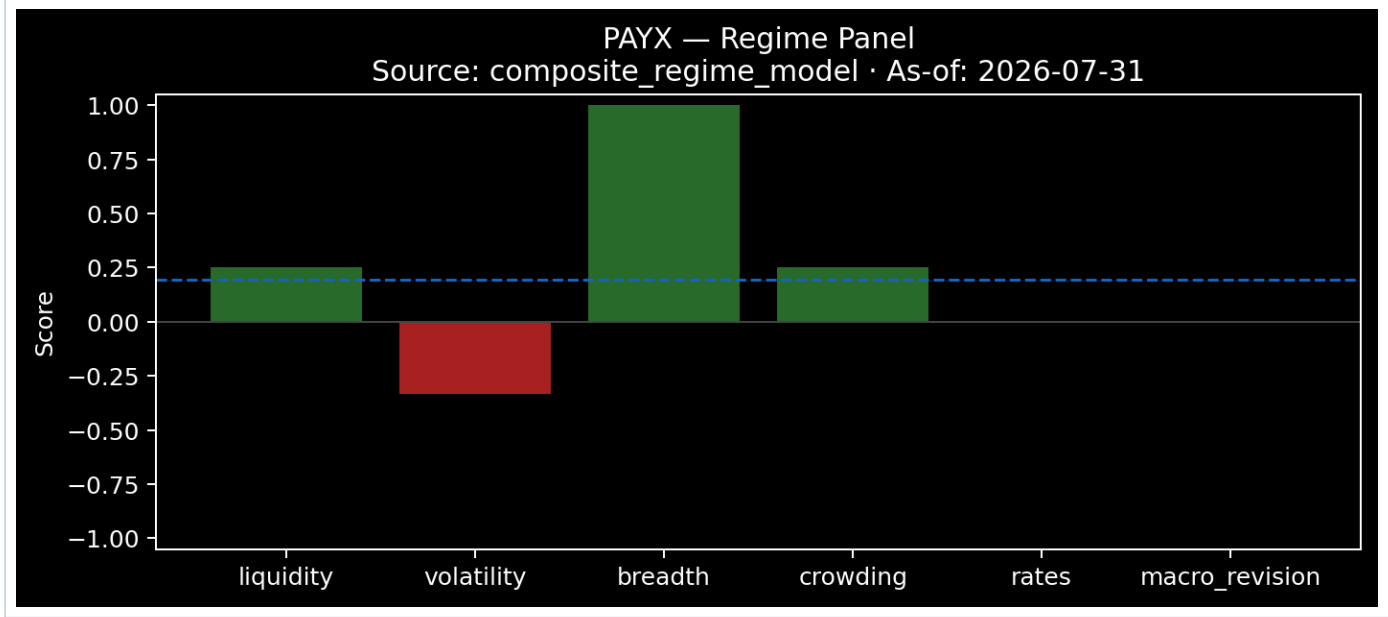


Figure 11. Market Regime Panel

Chart Read: Summarizes the macro regime drivers supporting or pressuring risk appetite.

Why it matters: regime alignment changes expected payoff and sizing discipline. Source: regime dataset · As-of: 2026-07-31

Technical Overview

SCORE

58.67/100

VERDICT

MONITOR

REGIME Trend-Up	ADVICE Hold / Neutral
TREND Uptrend	CONFIDENCE 17.35%

Price vs Moving Averages

Period	Position	Level
SMA 20	Above SMA	\$112.86
SMA 50	Above SMA	\$104.57
SMA 200	Above SMA	\$103.54
VWAP	Above SMA	\$96.09
Supertrend(10,3)	Above SMA	\$110.60

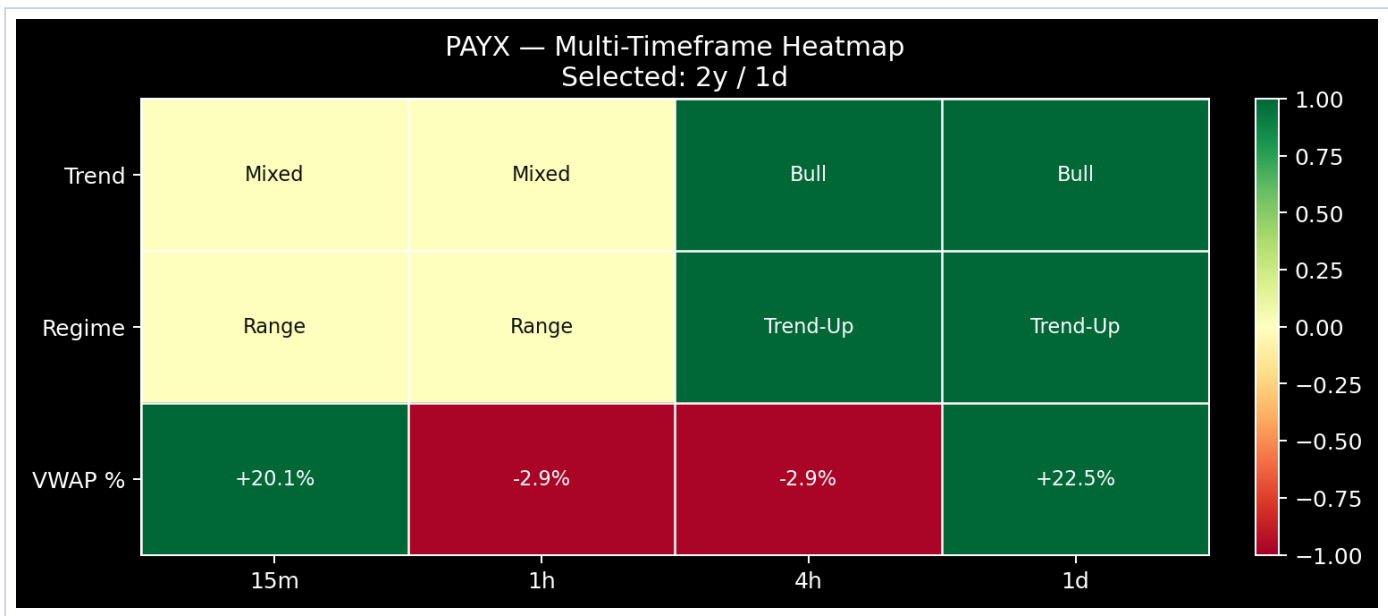


Figure 12. Multi-Timeframe Heatmap

Chart Read: Shows alignment or conflict across short and longer timeframes.

Why it matters: higher timeframe alignment improves follow-through odds. Source: technical indicators · As-of: 2026-08-03

Technical Scorecard

Setup Classification	
PRIMARY SETUP Breakout	REASON trend 100, VCP 27, vol 59
TREND / REGIME Uptrend / Trend-Up	VERDICT / ADVICE MONITOR / Hold / Neutral
STRUCTURE STAGE Stage 2 / Markup	TREND STACK Bull stack

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VALUE POSTURE

1/4 above

VCP / VOLATILITY STATE

26.6 / Expansion

Execution Card

TRIGGER

>124.74 or reclaim 116.17

INVALIDATION

<109.93 / EMA21 112.49

TARGET

133.15

REWARD / RISK

2.0:1

TIMEFRAME BIAS

Bull

Watch Conditions

Trigger	Level / Status
Donchian Breakout	>124.74
VWAP Posture	+22.5%
EMA9 Reclaim/Hold	116.17
EMA21 Reclaim/Hold	112.49
Target	133.15
Volume Confirmation	58.7
Compression Flags	NR7 No / Inside No / TTM Off

Invalidation Logic

Check	Threshold
ATR Stop	<109.93
Donchian Lower	<103.74
Supertrend	<110.60
EMA21	<112.49
Current Drawdown	-26.4%
Risk / Reward	2.0:1

Timeframe Agreement

Interval	Trend	Regime	Price vs VWAP
15m	Mixed	Range	+20.1%
1h	Mixed	Range	-2.9%
4h	Bull	Trend-Up	-2.9%
1d	Bull	Trend-Up	+22.5%
Consensus	100.00%	Bull	—

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Regime / Driver Breakdown

Driver	Value
Final Score	58.7
Confidence	17.3
Momentum	73.9
Trend	100.0
Risk Adjusted	95.0
Vol Stability	67.1
Drawdown	0.0
Volume Confirmation	58.7
ATR Percentile	99.2
Vol Clustering	-0.183
Gap Fill Prob	83.2%

Technical Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	technicals aligned
Implication	current structure supports acting on strength
Watch Next	breakout trigger, MTF bias Bull, and volume confirmation
Confidence	high

Market Structure Deep Dive

Support / Resistance Clusters

Side	Cluster
Resistance	118.12 (+0.4%) x3 [R2, R1, Fib R2]
Support	117.30 (-0.3%) x3 [Fib R1, EMA9, Pivot]

Distance Matrix

Level	Value	Distance
VWAP	96.09	+22.5%
EMA9	116.17	+1.3%
EMA21	112.49	+4.6%
SMA50	104.57	+12.5%
SMA200	103.54	+13.6%
Pivot	115.97	+1.5%

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Level	Value	Distance
R1	118.15	-0.4%
S1	114.67	+2.6%
Donchian Upper	124.74	-5.7%
Donchian Lower	103.74	+13.4%
Stop	109.93	+7.0%
Target	133.15	-11.6%

Candle / Bar Anatomy

O / H / L / C 118.75 / 119.96 / 116.97 / 117.67	BODY / UPPER WICK / LOWER WICK 36 / 41 / 23
RANGE / ATR 2.99 / 0.77x	CLOSING RANGE 23.3%
STREAK 2	

Historical Behavior Near Key MAs

MA	Behavior
DMA20	avg +0.4%
DMA50	avg +0.1%
DMA200	avg -0.1%

Compression / Expansion

Flag	Value
VCP Score	26.6
Volatility State	Expansion
TTM Squeeze	Off
NR7 / Inside Bar	No / No
ATR Percentile / Vol Clustering	99.2 / -0.183

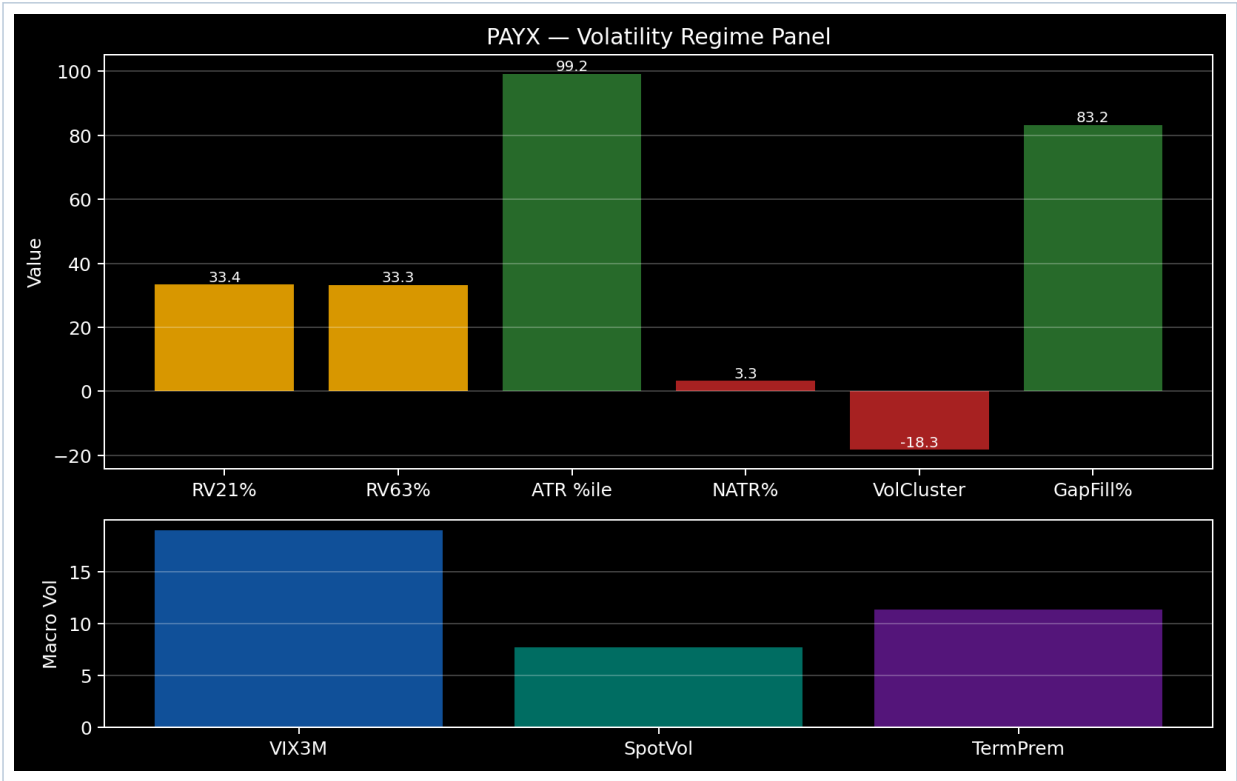


Figure 13. Volatility Regime Panel

Chart Read: Shows whether realized and implied volatility conditions favor expansion or compression.

Read: ATR is running near 3.3% of spot, so wider stops may be necessary. Why it matters: vol state affects breakout odds and stop placement. Source: technical indicators · As-of: 2026-08-03

Technical Indicators

Indicator	Value	Indicator	Value
RSI(14)	62.90	Stoch K/D	53.14/64.53
MACD	4.09	MACD Signal	3.97
MACD Hist	+0.12	Williams %R	-46.03
ADX(14)	30.54	CCI(20)	103.81
ATR(14)	3.87	NATR(14)%	3.29%
BB Upper	121.56	BB Lower	104.17
BB Position	77.63%	Z-Score	1.11
ROC(21)%	+10.64%	ROC(63)%	+26.50%
SAR	111.34	ER(10)	0.11
OBV Ratio	0.07	52W Pos%	57.71%

Pattern Signals

Signal	Status
NR7	—

Signal	Status
Inside Bar	—
Bull Pin Bar	—
Bear Pin Bar	—
Closing Range%	23.28%
Streak (bars)	2

Market Structure

WEINSTEIN STAGE Stage 2 (Uptrend)	VCP SCORE 26.61
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Risk Levels (ATR-based)

Level	Price	Note
Stop Loss	\$109.93	2x ATR below entry
Target	\$133.15	4x ATR above entry
Risk/Reward	2.00:1	—

Risk & Quantitative Metrics

Metric	21D	63D
Realized Vol (Ann)	0.33%	0.33%
Sharpe Ratio	3.81	3.00
Sortino Ratio	6.92	6.01
Calmar	26.80	15.69

CURRENT DRAWDOWN -26.35%	MAX DRAWDOWN (2Y) -46.45%
CVAR 95% -3.57%	KELLY FRACTION 0.20
HURST EXPONENT 0.95	SKEWNESS -0.57
KURTOSIS 0.48	VOL CLUSTERING -0.18
GAP FILL PROB% 83.21%	MONTHLY WIN RATE% 50.00%
MTF CONSENSUS% 100.00%	

Score Breakdown

Component	Score
Momentum	73.85
Trend	100.00
Mean Reversion	30.11
Bollinger	22.37
VWAP	0.00
Trend Strength	61.08
Vol Stability	67.12
Risk-Adjusted	94.97
Drawdown	0.00
Volume	58.75

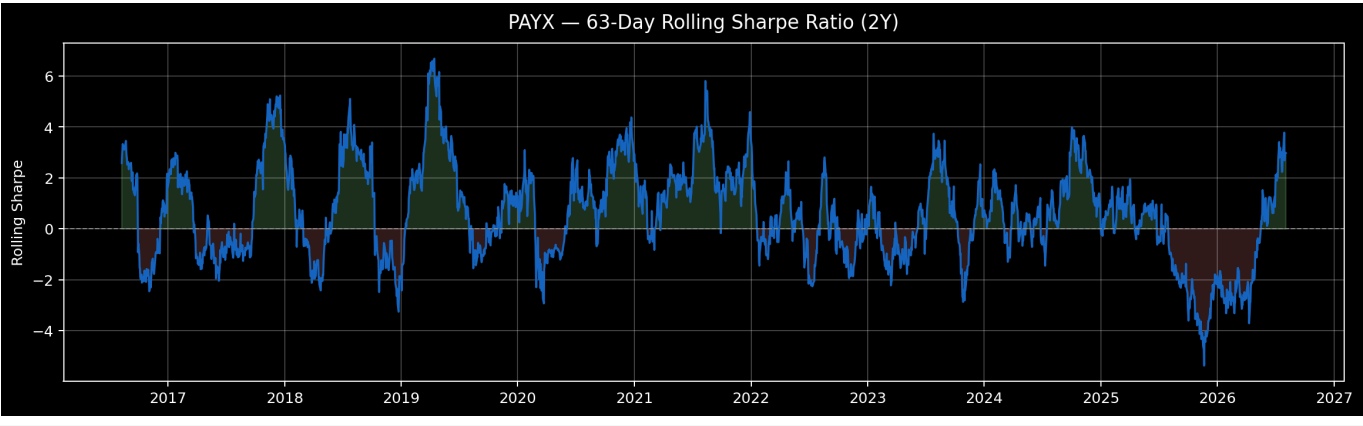


Figure 14. 63-Day Rolling Sharpe Ratio (2Y)

Chart Read: Shows whether returns have recently been efficient or unstable on a risk-adjusted basis.

Why it matters: shows whether recent returns have been efficient or unstable. Source: yfinance daily bars · As-of: 2026-08-03

NOTE
Primary sources: SEC companyfacts, local actions, yfinance fallback. Derived fields are labeled.

Issuer Profile

WEBSITE paychex.com	INVESTOR RELATIONS IR
SEC PROFILE CIK	CIK 0000723531
LISTING NasdaqGS / equity	COUNTRY United States
DOMICILE / LISTING United States / United States	EMPLOYEES 17.60K

IPO DATE
1983-08-26

STATUS REASON
active

ACTIVE LISTING
True

ETF / ADR / REIT
False / False / False

Identifiers

FIGI
BBG000BQSQ38

SHARE CLASS FIGI
BBG001S5V135

OPENFIGI MARKET SECTOR
Equity

COMPOSITE FIGI
BBG000BQSQ38

OPENFIGI TYPE
Common Stock / Common Stock

OPENFIGI EXCHANGE / MIC
US

Valuation

TRAILING P/E
23.87

PEG RATIO
2.06

EV/EBITDA
28.20

MARKET CAP
\$41.85B

FORWARD P/E
18.43

P/S RATIO
10.55

PRICE/BOOK
11.20

ENTERPRISE VALUE
\$45.34B

Profitability & Margins

GROSS MARGIN
67.20%

NET MARGIN
26.63%

EBITDA
\$1.61B

GROSS PROFIT
\$2.67B

OP MARGIN
38.32%

Income Statement (TTM)

REVENUE
\$3.97B

NET INCOME
\$420.60M

OPERATING INCOME
\$604.70M

EBITDA
\$1.61B

Most Recent Quarter

Q REVENUE \$1.61B	Q OP INCOME \$604.70M
Q NET INCOME \$420.60M	Q OP CASH FLOW \$580.90M

Point-in-Time Trend Snapshot

Metric	2026-05-31	2026-02-28	2025-11-30	2025-08-31
Revenue	\$1.61B	\$1.81B	\$1.56B	\$1.54B
Net Income	\$420.60M	\$560.30M	\$395.40M	\$383.80M
Operating Income	\$604.70M	\$792.00M	\$571.90M	\$541.90M
Operating Cash Flow	\$580.90M	\$812.50M	\$444.90M	\$718.40M

Fundamental Score Summary

GROWTH SCORE 50.00	QUALITY SCORE 78.32
RESILIENCE SCORE 53.26	CAPITAL ALLOCATION SCORE 54.05
OVERALL FUNDAMENTAL SCORE 58.91	OVERALL POSTURE Balanced

Margin Trend / Growth Regime

GROWTH REGIME Stable compounder	REVENUE TREND insufficient history
GROSS MARGIN TREND insufficient history	OPERATING MARGIN TREND insufficient history
NET MARGIN TREND insufficient history	

Balance Sheet & Resilience

TOTAL ASSETS \$16.17B	TOTAL LIABILITIES \$12.44B
STOCKHOLDERS EQUITY \$3.74B	CASH & EQUIVALENTS \$1.09B
TOTAL DEBT \$4.63B	NET DEBT \$3.54B
STRESS READ Liquidity pressure	NET DEBT / EBITDA 2.20
CURRENT / QUICK RATIO 1.15 / 0.30	DEBT / EQUITY 123.97

Cash Flow & Conversion

OPERATING CASH FLOW
\$1.18B

EARNINGS QUALITY
Cash-backed earnings

OCF / NET INCOME
2.80

Ownership & Short Interest

INSIDER HOLDING
10.36%

SHORT % FLOAT
6.06%

SHARES SHORT
19.23M

INST. HOLDING
85.66%

SHORT RATIO (DTC)
5.11

Growth & Yield

REVENUE GROWTH
12.50%

PAYOUT RATIO
90.59%

EPS FWD
6.38

EARNINGS GROWTH
43.40%

Capital Returns & Share Count

DIVIDEND YIELD
4.05%

DIVIDEND CADENCE
quarterly

SHARES OUTSTANDING
355.68M

SHAREHOLDER YIELD (EST.)
4.05%

BUYBACK / DILUTION REGIME
Stable

PAYOUT RATIO
90.59%

LATEST DIVIDEND
2026-07-27

SHARE COUNT TREND
insufficient history

YIELD DECOMPOSITION
dividend 4.05% + buyback -%

Valuation Context

TRAILING P/E CONTEXT
fair

EV / EBITDA CONTEXT
rich

FORWARD P/E CONTEXT
fair

FCF YIELD CONTEXT
insufficient coverage

OVERALL VALUATION POSTURE
Mixed

COVERAGE NOTE
peer/sector valuation history unavailable in current snapshot

Sector-Relative Fundamentals

NET MARGIN PERCENTILE
not meaningful

OPERATING MARGIN PERCENTILE
not meaningful

FUNDAMENTAL MOMENTUM SCORE
58.91

RELATIVE READ
insufficient peer sample

Fundamentals Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	balanced
Implication	fundamentals are serviceable but not dominant
Watch Next	watch growth regime, cash conversion, and share-count drift together
Confidence	medium

Valuation Sanity Flags

TRAILING PE 23.87	FORWARD PE 18.43
EV / EBITDA 28.20	PRICE / SALES 10.55
DIVIDEND YIELD 4.05%	FLAG COUNT 1

Flag	Read
Valuation	EV/EBITDA screens rich at 28.20

Fundamental Quality Panel

QUALITY SCORE 78.67	VERDICT Strong
GROWTH revenue 12.50%, earnings 43.40%	MARGINS gross 67.20%, operating 38.32%, net 26.63%
LIQUIDITY current 1.15, quick 0.30	DEBT / EQUITY 123.97

Fundamental Quality Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	fundamental quality strong
Implication	fundamentals support paying up for the name

Research only. Not investment advice. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Lens	Insight
Watch Next	watch growth, FCF yield, and leverage move in the same direction
Confidence	high

Curated Fundamentals

NOTE No curated fundamentals available.

Corporate Actions

NOTE Charts and relative returns use adjusted close when available; raw OHLC remains unadjusted.
--

Recent Dividends

Date	Amount	Source
2026-07-27	1.19	yfinance
2026-05-11	1.19	yfinance
2026-01-26	1.08	yfinance
2025-11-03	1.08	yfinance

Earnings & Revenue

Next Earnings

Next Date	EPS Estim...	Revenue Estimate
2026-09-29	1.32	\$1.63B

Estimate Range

Metric	Low	High
EPS Estimate	1.30	1.35
Revenue Estimate	\$1.62B	\$1.63B

EPS Surprise History (Last 8 Quarters)

Date	EPS Estim...	Reported E...	Surprise
2026-09-29	1.32	—	—
2026-06-24	1.31	1.32	OK 0.91%
2026-03-25	1.67	1.71	OK 2.31%
2025-12-19	1.23	1.26	OK 2.40%
2025-09-30	1.20	1.22	OK 1.42%

Research only. Not investment advice. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Date	EPS Estim...	Reported E...	Surprise
2025-06-25	1.20	1.19	DOWN -0.66%
2025-03-26	1.48	1.49	OK 0.70%
2024-12-19	1.12	1.14	OK 1.51%

Annual Revenue & Net Income

Year	Revenue	Net Income	Net Margin
2026	\$6.51B	\$1.76B	27.03%
2025	\$5.57B	\$1.66B	29.74%
2024	\$5.28B	\$1.69B	32.03%
2023	\$5.01B	\$1.56B	31.10%

Share Buybacks (Annual)

Year	Repurchases
2026	\$611.00M
2025	\$104.50M
2024	\$169.20M
2023	\$0.00

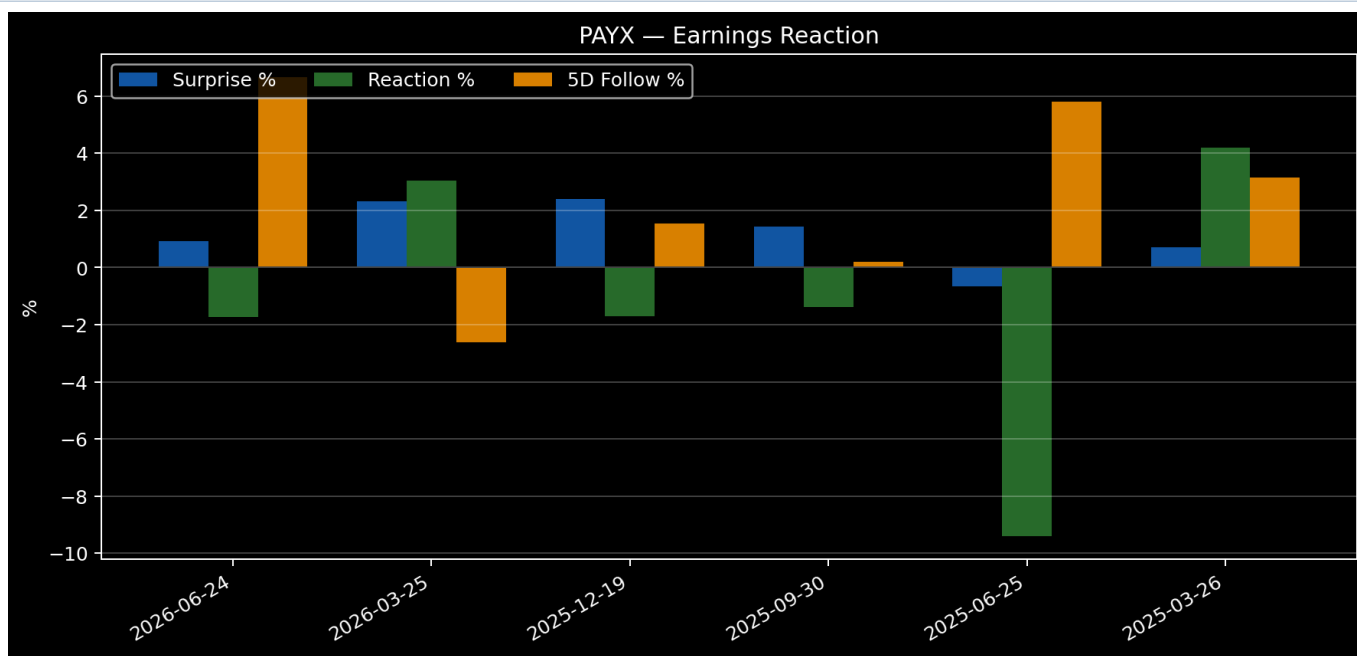


Figure 15. Earnings Reaction

Chart Read: Shows how the stock has typically moved around earnings events.

Why it matters: event reaction history sets expectations into the next print. Source: earnings history · As-of: 2024-12-19

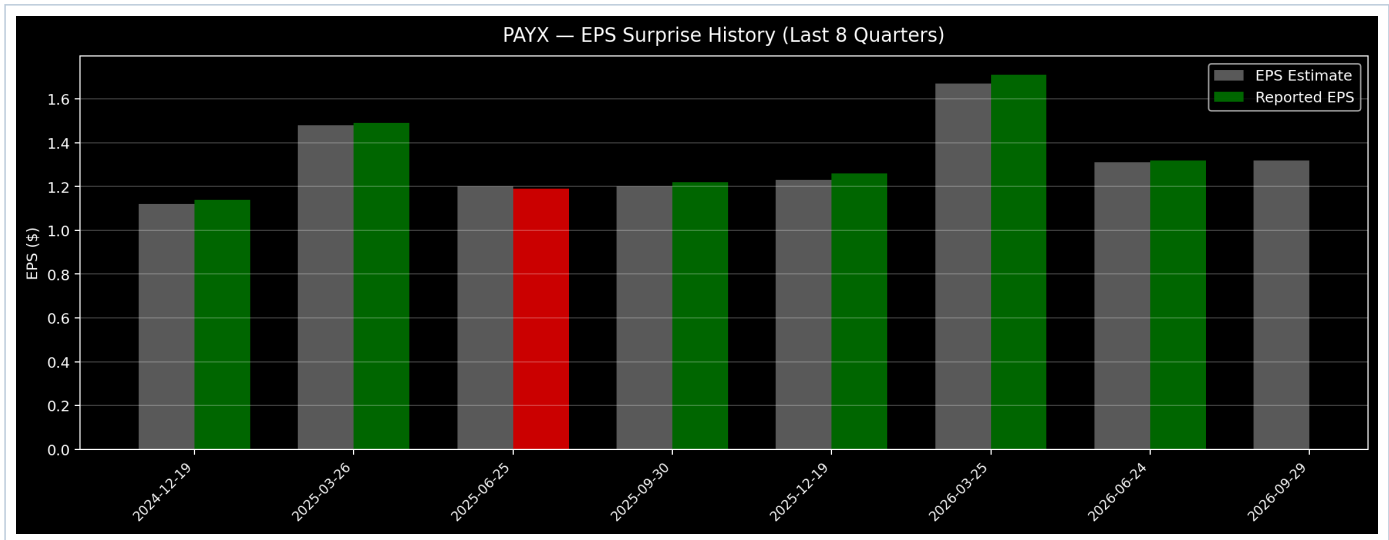


Figure 16. EPS Surprise History

Chart Read: Shows whether earnings have tended to beat or miss expectations.

Why it matters: surprise consistency helps separate narrative from execution. Source: earnings history · As-of: 2024-12-19

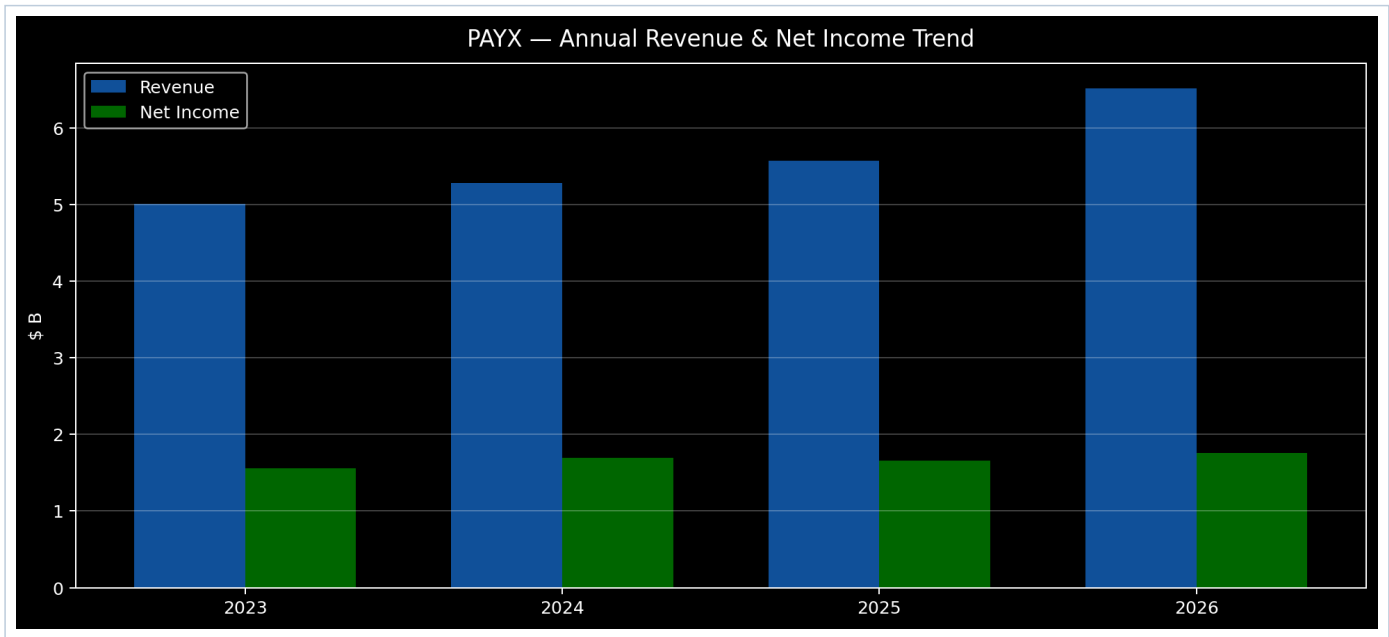


Figure 17. Annual Revenue & Net Income Trend

Chart Read: Shows the slope and consistency of top-line growth and profitability.

Why it matters: slope and consistency matter more than one quarter in isolation. Source: annual revenue history · As-of: 1970-01-01

Options Snapshot

NEAREST EXPIRY 2026-08-21	ATM IV (CALLS) 38.12%
ATM IV (PUTS) 43.44%	PUT/CALL RATIO 0.06

TOTAL CALL OI
5.39K

TOTAL PUT OI
3.31K

Options Expected Move

FRONT EXPIRY
2026-08-21

DTE
17

ATM IV USED
38.12%

EXPECTED MOVE
+/-11.65 (9.90%)

IMPLIED RANGE
106.02 to 129.32

Analyst Consensus

RECOMMENDATION
HOLD

ANALYST COUNT
14

TARGET (MEAN)
\$109.57

TARGET RANGE
\$95.00 - \$150.00

Rating	Count	Share
Strong Buy	0	0.00%
Buy	2	# 11.11%
Hold	12	##### 66.67%
Sell	3	## 16.67%
Strong Sell	1	# 5.56%

Recent Upgrades / Downgrades

Date	Firm	Action	Grade
2026-06-30	Morgan Stanley	Reiterate	Equal-Weight
2026-06-25	UBS	Reiterate	Neutral
2026-06-25	JP Morgan	Reiterate	Underweight
2026-06-17	Stifel	Reiterate	Hold
2026-06-15	Citigroup	Upgrade	Neutral -> Buy
2026-06-08	TD Cowen	Reiterate	Hold
2026-04-13	UBS	Reiterate	Neutral
2026-03-26	JP Morgan	Reiterate	Underweight

Analyst Insight

Lens	Insight
------	---------

Lens	Insight
Read	street view mixed
Implication	consensus is not a strong differentiator
Watch Next	watch target dispersion and rating breadth for revision pressure
Confidence	medium / conflicting signals

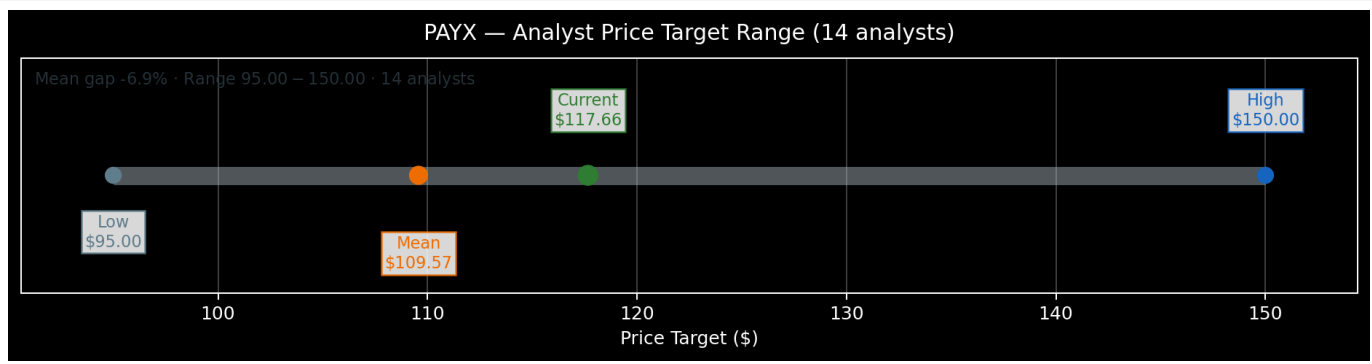


Figure 18. Analyst Price Target Range

Chart Read: Shows how optimistic or conservative the street target range currently is.

Read: consensus implies -6.9% with 50.2% target spread. Why it matters: shows how much of the upside case is already in consensus. Source: analyst consensus · As-of: 2026-08-03

Ownership / Crowding Context

CROWDING READ Distribution risk	TOP INSTITUTIONAL HOLDER Capital International Investors
TOP INSTITUTIONAL VALUE \$3.22B	TOP-5 INSTITUTIONAL CONCENTRATION 27.91%
INSTITUTIONAL HOLDER COUNT 5	TOP MUTUAL FUND HOLDER WASHINGTON MUTUAL INVESTORS FUND
TOP-5 MUTUAL FUND CONCENTRATION 13.21%	MUTUAL FUND % OUT (TOP-5) 14.33%
RECENT INSIDER BUYS / SELLS 0 / 2	RECENT INSIDER NET VALUE \$-602.37K

Ownership Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	distribution risk
Implication	holder base can amplify downside if conviction breaks
Watch Next	watch insider net activity against concentration changes
Confidence	high

Ownership Change Over Time

STATUS Unavailable	REASON Need at least two major-holder history snapshots to compute...
--	---

SEC Insider Transactions

AS OF 2026-07-20	BUY / SELL COUNT 18 / 17
NET SHARES 468,539	NET VALUE \$11.60M

SEC Insider Transactions | Score: 58.67/100 | Verdict: Monitor for reclaim | Price: 117.67 | Next Earnings: 2026-09-29

Date	Insider Name	Label	Direction	Shares	Price	Owned After
2026-07-20	DOODY JOSEPH	J	—	164	0.00	23,922
2026-07-20	Schrader Robert L.	Open Market Or Private Sale	sell	2,600	115.09	18,547
2026-07-20	DOODY JOSEPH	J	—	164	0.00	725
2026-07-17	MUCCI MARTIN	Gift	—	9,309	113.98	434,891.33
2026-07-17	Simmons Christopher C	Open Market Or Private Sale	sell	2,615	115.92	3,420

Top Institutional Holders

Holder	Shares	Value	% Held	As Of
Capital International Investors	29.95M	\$3.22B	8.36%	2026-03-31
Blackrock Inc.	28.41M	\$3.06B	7.93%	2026-03-31
Vanguard Capital Management LLC	20.97M	\$2.25B	5.85%	2026-03-31
Vanguard Portfolio Management LLC	15.25M	\$1.64B	4.26%	2026-03-31
State Street Corporation	14.05M	\$1.51B	3.92%	2026-03-31

Mutual Fund Holders

Holder	Shares	% Out	Value	As Of
WASHINGTON MUTUAL INVESTORS FUND	14.17M	3.95%	\$1.52B	2026-04-30
VANGUARD INDEX FUNDS-Vanguard Total Stock Market Index Fund	10.25M	2.86%	\$1.10B	2026-03-31
SCHWAB STRATEGIC TRUST-Schwab US Dividend Equity ETF	10.00M	2.79%	\$1.08B	2026-02-28
AMERICAN FUNDS FUNDAMENTAL INVESTORS	8.76M	2.44%	\$941.94M	2026-03-31
VANGUARD INDEX FUNDS-Vanguard 500 Index Fund	8.21M	2.29%	\$882.79M	2026-03-31

Insider Activity (yfinance)

Filing Date	Insider Name	Title	Trade Type	Price	Qty	Value
2026-07-20	SCHRADER ROBERT L.	Chief Financial Officer	DOWN S	115.09	2600	299234
2026-07-17	MUCCI MARTIN	Chairman of the Board	N/A Other	113.98	9309	1061058
2026-07-17	SIMMONS CHRISTOPHER C	Officer and Treasurer	DOWN S	115.92	2615	303131
2026-07-15	SCHRADER ROBERT L.	Chief Financial Officer	N/A Grant	0.00	4364	0
2026-07-15	ANTE ADAM BROOKS	Officer	N/A Grant	0.00	3409	0
2026-07-15	BERGSTROM RYAN NORMAN	Officer	N/A Grant	0.00	3409	0
2026-07-15	GIBSON JOHN B JR	Chief Executive Officer	N/A Grant	0.00	14318	0
2026-07-15	SIMMONS CHRISTOPHER C	Officer and Treasurer	N/A Grant	0.00	1818	0

Insider Pressure Summary

BUY COUNT 0	SELL COUNT 2
NET VALUE \$-602.37K	NET VALUE / MARKET CAP -0.00%

Recent News

NOTE

Narrative: mixed headline tape without a dominant catalyst.

Coverage: 4 relevant headlines reviewed; 4 dated items.

Lens	Headlines
Bullish	No flagged headlines
Bearish	No flagged headlines
Neutral	Paychex (PAYX) Board Change And Dividend Stand Out, Is It Fully Priced? ; Why Is Paychex (PAYX) Up 14.4% Since Last Earnings Report? ; A Paychex Chairman Gave Away 9,309 Shares but Keeps Roughly \$50 Million

Date	Publisher	Tag	Impact	Headline
2026-07-25	Simply Wall St.	general	[LOW] [RECENT]	Paychex (PAYX) Board Change And Dividend Stand Out, Is It Fully Priced?
2026-07-24	Zacks	earnings	[HIGH] [RECENT]	Why Is Paychex (PAYX) Up 14.4% Since Last Earnings Report?
2026-07-22	Motley Fool	general	[LOW] [RECENT]	A Paychex Chairman Gave Away 9,309 Shares but Keeps Roughly \$50 Million
2026-07-22	Motley Fool	general	[LOW] [RECENT]	Paychex CFO Sells 12% of His Common Shares With Stock Down 24% This Past Year

Short Sale Pressure

AS OF 2026-07-31	SHORT VOLUME 593399.00
SHORT EXEMPT VOLUME 448.00	TOTAL VOLUME 789385.00
SHORT VOLUME RATIO 75.17%	SHORT EXEMPT VOLUME RATIO 0.06%
5D AVG SHORT VOLUME RATIO 69.42%	20D AVG SHORT VOLUME RATIO 72.78%
READ Normal	

Short Interest Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	normal
Implication	short participation is not changing the thesis yet
Watch Next	watch short ratio versus 20D average and price response together
Confidence	high

Event Risk Calendar

Event	Date	Distance	Note
Earnings	2026-09-29	56d	scheduled
Dividend	2026-07-27	8d ago	last cash event
8-K	2026-07-21	14d ago	latest filing

Catalyst / Event Risk

Driver	Status
Next Earnings	2026-09-29
Latest Dividend	2026-07-27
Analyst Target Gap	-6.88%

SEC Filing Timeline

LATEST FORM 8-K	LATEST FILING DATE 2026-07-21
LATEST REPORT DATE 2026-07-16	LATEST FILING LAG 5.00d

8-K COUNT (90D)

2

10-Q COUNT (365D)

2

10-K COUNT (365D)

1

Form	Filing Date	Report D...	Lag	Type
8-K	2026-07-21	2026-07-16	5.00d	8-K
10-K	2026-07-17	2026-05-31	47.00d	10-K
8-K	2026-06-24	2026-06-24	0.00d	8-K
10-Q	2026-03-26	2026-02-28	26.00d	10-Q
8-K	2026-03-25	2026-03-25	0.00d	8-K

End Summary

Lens	Close
Profile	full
Action Bias	Hold / Neutral
Score / Verdict	58.67 / MONITOR
Risk Box	stop 109.93 / trade target 133.15
Analyst Mean Gap	-6.88%
Flow Context	\$72.37M
Regime / Catalyst	neutral / 2026-09-29

Closing Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	setup remains actionable into the next catalyst window
Implication	size to the setup only if flow, relative strength, and event path stay aligned
Watch Next	watch stop discipline, benchmark-relative tape, and catalyst timing together
Confidence	medium / stale inputs

Appendix

NOTE

Reference material, data provenance, and lower-priority diagnostics.

DATASET ROOT

cerberus_data

FRESH / STALE / UNKNOWN

0 / 25 / 1

TRACKED DATASETS

26

Dataset	As Of	Age	SLA	Status	Source
SEC Insider	2026-07-20	377.7h	no SLA	stale	cerberus_data
SEC Events	2026-07-21	353.7h	no SLA	stale	sec_submissions
NAAIM	2026-07-22	329.7h	no SLA	stale	cerberus_data
aaii_sentiment	2026-07-23	305.7h	no SLA	stale	aaii_sentiment
Actions	2026-07-27	205.7h	no SLA	stale	cerberus_data
cboe_bxm	2026-07-31	113.7h	no SLA	stale	cboe_bxm
cboe_longvol	2026-07-31	113.7h	no SLA	stale	cboe_longvol
cboe_lovol	2026-07-31	113.7h	no SLA	stale	cboe_lovol

+18 additional datasets tracked in companion manifest.

Methodology

NOTE
Definitions

Topic	Note
Score Components	Momentum, Trend, Mean Reversion, Bollinger, VWAP, Trend Strength, Vol Stability, Risk Adjusted, Drawdown, Volume Confirmation
Flow Divergence Logic	Flow divergence compares 5D/20D price returns against cumulative major and retail net flow from local stock_flows; positive major flow with flat/down price flags accumulation, negative major flow with resilient price flags distribution.
Benchmark Selection	Benchmarks prefer index membership and sector mapping from local security/index snapshots; current order SPY, XLK.

Fallback Usage

Dataset	Handling	Severity
fundamentals	fundamentals dataset unavailable	optional
options_summary	options_summary dataset unavailable	optional
sec_company_tickers	sec_company_tickers dataset unavailable	optional

NOTE

Report generated by SanCapital Cerberus — for research purposes only.

List of Figures

- Figure 1: Price Chart - Candlestick + SMA + Volume + RSI (1Y)
- Figure 2: Risk Map and Execution Levels
- Figure 3: Catalyst and Event Timeline
- Figure 4: Score Mix Breakdown
- Figure 5: Relative Strength Ratio
- Figure 6: Breadth and Leadership Context
- Figure 7: Peer Relative Performance (1Y, Base=100)
- Figure 8: Peer 5D Major Flow
- Figure 9: Major and Retail Flow Trend
- Figure 10: Macro and Tape Overlay
- Figure 11: Market Regime Panel
- Figure 12: Multi-Timeframe Heatmap
- Figure 13: Volatility Regime Panel
- Figure 14: 63-Day Rolling Sharpe Ratio (2Y)
- Figure 15: Earnings Reaction
- Figure 16: EPS Surprise History
- Figure 17: Annual Revenue & Net Income Trend
- Figure 18: Analyst Price Target Range

Document Control

Report Schema	2
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